

ECON 3040 Course Syllabus
Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory, Fall 2026
[Canvas course page](#)

Instructor:

Ryan Chahrour (ryan.chahrour@cornell.edu)

Office hours: Mon @ 4:30-5:30pm and by [online appointment](#) (Uris 428)

Lectures:

Tue/Thur @ 10:10-11:25am, Phillips Hall 101

Teaching Assistants:

Jonathan Lambrinos (jgl229@cornell.edu; Sections 201, 202)

Office hours: Thur @ 4:30-5:30pm, Fri @ 11:15am-1:15pm (Uris 465)

Jiayin Bian (jb2846@cornell.edu; Sections 203, 204)

Office hours: Tue @ 1:00-3:00pm, Wed @ 3:00-4:00pm (Uris 457)

Sections:

Sections 201/202: Fri @ 9:05-9:55am/10:10-11:00am, Statler 351

Sections 203/204: Fri @ 1:25-2:15pm/2:30-3:20pm, Rockefeller 230

Sections are an opportunity to review and practice the tools we learn in class. You will work through additional problems, examples, and extensions that reinforce your understanding of the lecture materials. Attendance is not monitored, but is strongly encouraged.

Course Overview:

This course provides an introduction to the modern theory and practice of macroeconomics. It covers a variety of the central questions in macroeconomics including: What are the determinants of long-run economic growth? Why do economies regularly experience booms and recessions? Why is there unemployment? What determines the value of money in an economy? The course focuses particular attention on how macroeconomic policy (monetary and fiscal) affects outcomes in these dimensions, and on using the tools of the field to evaluate alternative policy responses to current events.

The course website includes a schedule of expected lecture topics and assignment due dates.

Prerequisites:

The prerequisites for this course are ECON 1120 with a minimum grade of B- and MATH 1110 with a minimum grade of C. If you have not satisfied these prerequisites, you must communicate with me to obtain written permission to take the course.

Additionally, if you have received advanced placement credit for Introductory Macroeconomics and Fall 2026 is your first semester of college, you must also pass the Macroeconomics Placement Exam (see the [Economics Department Website](#) for more details).

Required Text:

N. Gregory Mankiw. *Macroeconomics*. Worth Publishers, 11th edition, 2022

(Note: the 12th edition is also acceptable.)

Coursework:

The coursework in this class will consist of six brief in-class quizzes, two preliminary exams, and a cumulative final exam.

The in-class quizzes will be based on problem sets assigned to the class. Solutions will be provided, but problem sets will not be graded. Instead, on dates with problem sets “due”, we will have brief closed-book quizzes on the material related to the problem set. During this time, you may not access any notes or electronic information of any type. You must be in class to receive a grade for the quiz, and there will not be any makeup quizzes. However, your two lowest quiz scores will be excluded from your average quiz score.

Grading:

Each student will be assigned a numerical grade based on a weighted average of their performance across the exams and quizzes. Each preliminary exam will count for 20% of the final grade, the final will count for 40%, and the average score on quizzes will count for 10%. The remaining 10% will go to your highest exam percentage score, whether that is one of your preliminary exams or your final.

Letter grades will be assigned according to a curve. Students in the top 35% of the course will receive a letter in the A-range. Students in the next 40% will receive a letter in the B-range. Students in the next 20% will receive a letter in the C-range. Grades for students in the lower 5%, and pluses and minuses, will be assigned at my discretion.

Please note that I only curve grades “up”, so that this curve provides a lower bound on grades in the course. For example, a final score of 85% might correspond to a letter grade in the A-range, but will never map into a letter below a straight-B.

If you think that an exam has been graded incorrectly, you may request a regrade within one week after the exam is returned. To do so, you must submit a written note describing why you believe your grade is incorrect. I will then regrade the entire exam, so that your final score may go up or down.

Accommodations:

If you are a student with a documented disability seeking reasonable accommodations in this course, please follow the procedures described at <https://sds.cornell.edu>. Two weeks advance notice and appropriate documentation are required for accommodations.

Excuses:

The [Faculty Handbook](#) lists several types of situations in which faculty are encouraged to make accommodations for missed work. However, the determination as to whether a particular case warrants accommodation is ultimately the decision of the faculty member. Here is how four common cases are handled in this course:

1. Short-term illness, or family or personal emergency: Please contact me as soon as possible,

but before the exam start time at the latest, and briefly explain your situation. I will make a proposal based on your particular situation.

2. Religious observances. While I do my best not to schedule exams or quizzes during religious holidays, please contact me at least two weeks in advance if an exam or quiz date/time conflicts with a religious holiday.
3. Athletics and Extracurricular Activities. Students in varsity athletics or recognized extracurricular activities must provide the standard permission slip from the staff responsible for the activity at least two weeks before the exam.
4. Employment interviews. I generally will not reschedule an exam to accommodate an employment interview, and I strongly encourage you avoid scheduling an interview that conflicts with exam periods.

Academic Integrity:

These policies have been designed with the ubiquitous presence of LLM tools in mind. Please read these policies carefully and ask questions at the start of the course. I hope to maximize your learning, reduce the temptation to cheat, and increase your confidence that everyone's grade in the course will reflect their mastery of the material.

General Rule: All graded work in this course is to be completed in a supervised setting without devices, and every graded submission must be entirely your own work. Outside of our supervised assessments, you are welcome to use LLMs to support your learning in whatever way suits you.

If you cheat on any graded work – for example, by using unauthorized assistance, sharing answers, or presenting others' work as your own – the result is (1) an automatic failure in the course and (2) a report to the College of Arts and Sciences, following the procedures required by the University. See the University's [code of academic integrity](#) for a full discussion of policies and procedures.

Exams & Quizzes: Exams are closed book, with permission to bring one physical 8.5x11 note sheet (two sided). Quizzes are closed book, with no outside material.

Devices: No access to any electronic device or information is allowed during exams or quizzes. This includes calculators, computers, phones, tablets, smartwatches, or smart glasses. If it can be internet-enabled, it is not allowed.

To keep this rule simple and fair to everyone, I will enforce it regardless of intent: if you are observed accessing a prohibited device during an exam or quiz you will receive a zero on that assessment. The safest course is to store your devices securely for the entire exam period. On exam days, I encourage you to leave your device behind entirely.

Restrooms: During exams, restroom breaks are limited and, for shorter exams, may not be available. Specific procedures will be provided in each exam's instructions.

Exceptions: Exceptions to these policies may apply with documented SDS accommodations.

Communication:

Questions about course material: Please bring these to office hours or to the Canvas discussion board. The discussion board is the fastest way to get an answer, and if you are wondering about something, several of your classmates almost certainly are too. I read the board regularly, as do the TAs.

Questions about your individual situation: Email me directly — illness, exam conflicts, accommodations, or anything you would rather not post publicly. Please put “ECON 3040” in the subject line.

Response times: I answer email within two business days, and if I do not you may follow up on your message. I do not generally respond in the evenings or on weekends, so please do not count on a reply the night before an exam.

Note: I do not monitor comments left on Canvas/Gradescope assignments or grades. If you need a response, use email or the discussion board.

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